

Marital Status of the Population Aged 15 Years and Over

Table 9.3 presents the distribution of the population aged 15 years and over in Sri Lanka by marital status and sex, according to the Population and Housing Censuses 2012 and 2024.

Table 9.3 : Population Aged 15 Years and Over by Marital Status and Sex, 2012 and 2024

Marital status	2012				2024			
	Male		Female		Male		Female	
	Number	%	Number	%	Number	%	Number	%
Total	7,266,234	100.0	7,961,539	100.0	8,231,814	100.0	9,043,147	100.0
Never married	2,179,099	30.0	1,748,503	22.0	2,527,794	30.7	2,065,535	22.8
Married	4,921,044	67.7	5,401,061	67.9	5,417,431	65.8	5,743,629	63.6
Widow	97,532	1.3	695,415	8.7	175,421	2.1	1,058,997	11.7
Divorced	14,847	0.2	26,328	0.3	28,952	0.4	45,403	0.5
Legal separated	11,135	0.2	19,778	0.2	17,047	0.2	27,857	0.3
Separated (not legally)	42,577	0.6	70,454	0.9	65,169	0.8	101,726	1.1

According to Table 9.3, in 2024, the number of never-married males exceeded that of never married females by 462,259. Similarly, the number of married females exceeded that of married males by 326,198. Furthermore, the number of widowed females exceeded the number of widowed males by 883,576.

Comparing 2012 and 2024, the percentage of widowed males has increased from 1.3 percent to 2.1 percent, while the percentage of widowed females has increased from 8.7 percent to 11.7 percent. The percentage of divorced males has increased from 0.2 percent to 0.4 percent, while the percentage of divorced females has increased from 0.3 percent to 0.5 percent.

Figure 9.1 shows the percentage distribution of the population aged 15 years and over, by marital status and sex, according to the Census of Population and Housing 2024.

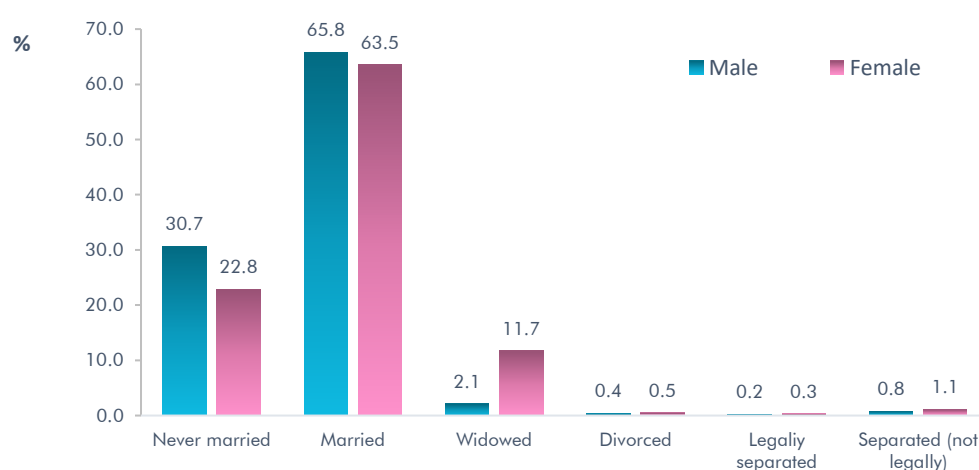


Figure 9.1 : Percentage Distribution of the Population Aged 15 Years and Over, by Marital Status and Sex, 2024